

D360

HRM Capstone

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A distribution company started the year with 480 employees and ended with 520. During the year it hired 100 people and had 60 separations. It also won a regional best-employer award. What was its annual turnover rate?

- A. 12.0%
- B. 12.5%
- C. 20.0%
- D. 11.5%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A firm with an average headcount of 250 reports annual turnover of 18%. How many employees separated?

- A. 1,389
- B. 205
- C. 18
- D. 45

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

Last year a hospital spent \$180,000 on agency fees and job ads and \$120,000 on recruiter salaries and interview time, and made 150 hires. Its time-to-fill averaged 42 days, and the recruiting team moved to a new floor. What was cost per hire?

- A. \$7,143
- B. \$1,200
- C. \$300,000
- D. \$2,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A retention program cost \$80,000. HR estimates it prevented 10 exits, each of which would have cost \$20,000 to replace. The program was designed by an outside consultant and ran for nine months. What is the program's ROI?

- A. 60%
- B. \$120,000
- C. 150%
- D. 250%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A \$50,000 training program must earn an ROI of 40%. What total benefit must it produce?

- A. \$125,000
- B. \$70,000
- C. \$40,000
- D. \$20,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A discount grocery chain competes on having the lowest prices in its region. It has 140 stores and a new logo. A consultant proposes above-market pay for all associates plus a week-long leadership retreat to build a luxury service culture. How should HR evaluate the proposal?

- A. Strong fit, because the strategy calls for premium service.
- B. It cannot be judged until each of the 140 stores is surveyed.
- C. Poor fit: HR practices should support cost leadership, and a costly luxury-service package works against it.
- D. Strong fit, because higher pay always improves results.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A hospital system tracks the percentage of nurses who complete advanced certification each year. The system has seven campuses and a new CFO. On a balanced scorecard, which perspective does this measure belong to?

- A. Learning and growth
- B. Financial
- C. Customer
- D. Internal business process

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

After a leadership training program, HR checks whether managers are actually holding weekly one-on-ones with their staff three months later. The course was held at a lakeside resort and scored 4.8 out of 5 on the end-of-day survey. Which Kirkpatrick level is HR measuring?

- A. Level 1: Reaction
- B. Level 2: Learning
- C. Level 4: Results
- D. Level 3: Behavior

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

HR wants to know whether a safety training program lowered the plant's injury rate. Which Kirkpatrick level is this?

- A. Level 1: Reaction
- B. Level 4: Results
- C. Level 3: Behavior
- D. Level 2: Learning

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

In an HR SWOT analysis for a regional bank, the team lists that a new state law will require paid family leave for all employers next year. The bank has 2,200 employees and strong brand recognition. Where does the new law belong?

- A. An external factor: an opportunity or threat depending on its effect on the bank.
- B. A weakness, because it adds cost.
- C. Nowhere; laws belong only in a PESTLE analysis.
- D. A strength, because of the bank's strong brand.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which item belongs in the Weaknesses box of an HR SWOT?

- A. A highly rated internal mentoring program.
- B. The HR system cannot produce turnover reports by department.
- C. A shortage of nurses in the regional labor market.
- D. A competitor raising its starting wages.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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12.

An HR analyst at a 5,000-employee insurer finds that employees who joined the voluntary wellness program have 30% lower turnover than those who did not. The program is run by a well-known vendor and costs \$150 per person. The CHRO wants to announce that the program cuts turnover. What is the best response?

- A. Compute ROI on the \$150 cost to prove the effect.
- B. The program must be raising turnover among non-participants.
- C. The data show correlation, not causation; compare similar groups or run a controlled pilot before claiming the program cut turnover.
- D. The claim is proven because the gap is 30%.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A distribution company started the year with 480 employees and ended with 520. During the year it hired 100 people and had 60 separations. ~~It also won a regional best employer award.~~ What was its annual turnover rate?

Target word: turnover rate **Decides:** Average headcount = $(480 + 520) \div 2 = 500$.

A	Correct	$60 \div 500 = 12\%$.
B	Dropped element	Divides by starting headcount; drops the averaging step.
C	Camouflage	Uses hires, not separations.
D	Wrong stem number	Divides by ending headcount.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

A firm with an average headcount of 250 reports annual turnover of 18%. How many employees separated?

Target word: solve for separations **Decides:** Separations = rate $\times$ average headcount.

A	Inverted operation	Divides headcount by the rate.
B	Confusion set	That is the number who stayed.
C	Wrong stem number	Reads the percentage as a count.
D	Correct	$0.18 \times 250 = 45$.

3. Answer D Concept 2

Last year a hospital spent \$180,000 on agency fees and job ads and \$120,000 on recruiter salaries and interview time, and made 150 hires. ~~Its time to fill averaged 42 days, and the recruiting team moved to a new floor.~~ What was cost per hire?

Target word: cost per hire **Decides:** Include both external and internal costs.

A	Camouflage	Divides total cost by time-to-fill days.
B	Dropped element	Counts only external costs.
C	Wrong stem number	Total spend, not per hire.
D	Correct	$(\$180,000 + \$120,000) \div 150 = \$2,000$.

4. Answer C Concept 3

A retention program cost \$80,000. HR estimates it prevented 10 exits, each of which would have cost \$20,000 to replace. ~~The program was designed by an outside consultant and ran for nine months.~~ What is the program's ROI?

Target word: ROI percent **Decides:** Benefit \$200,000; net gain \$120,000 over cost \$80,000.

A	Inverted operation	Divides the net gain by benefit instead of cost.
B	Adjacent category	Net benefit in dollars, not a return rate.
C	Correct	$(\$200,000 - \$80,000) \div \$80,000 = 150\%$.
D	Dropped element	Benefit $\div$ cost; skips subtracting cost.

5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

A \$50,000 training program must earn an ROI of 40%. What total benefit must it produce?

Target word: solve for benefit **Decides:** Benefit = cost × (1 + ROI).

A	Inverted operation	Divides cost by the rate.
B	Correct	$\$50,000 \times 1.40 = \$70,000$.
C	Wrong stem number	Reads 40% as dollars.
D	Dropped element	Only the net gain; leaves out recovering the cost.

6. Answer C Concept 4

A discount grocery chain competes on having the lowest prices in its region. ~~It has 140 stores and a new logo.~~ A consultant proposes above-market pay for all associates plus a week-long leadership retreat to build a luxury service culture. How should HR evaluate the proposal?

Target word: fit with strategy **Decides:** Strategy is cost leadership.

A	Confusion set	Confuses cost leadership with differentiation.
B	Camouflage	Store count does not decide strategic fit.
C	Correct	Vertical fit means HR serves the business strategy.
D	Absolute language	Pay effects depend on strategy and cost.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A hospital system tracks the percentage of nurses who complete advanced certification each year. ~~The system has seven campuses and a new CFO.~~ On a balanced scorecard, which perspective does this measure belong to?

Target word: scorecard perspective **Decides:** It measures workforce capability.

A	Correct	People skills and capabilities belong here.
B	Camouflage	Answers the new-CFO detail; certification rate is not a financial measure.
C	Confusion set	Customer measures cover patient satisfaction or retention.
D	Adjacent category	Process measures cover how work flows, such as cycle time or error rates.

8. Answer D Concept 6

After a leadership training program, HR checks whether managers are actually holding weekly one-on-ones with their staff three months later. ~~The course was held at a lakeside resort and scored 4.8 out of 5 on the end-of-day survey.~~ Which Kirkpatrick level is HR measuring?

Target word: Kirkpatrick level **Decides:** On-the-job behavior months later.

A	Camouflage	The survey score is reaction, but that is not what HR is measuring now.
B	Adjacent category	Learning is tested knowledge or skill at the end of training.
C	Confusion set	Results are business outcomes such as turnover or output.
D	Correct	Checks whether training changed what people do at work.

9. Answer B Concept 6 · transfer

HR wants to know whether a safety training program lowered the plant's injury rate. Which Kirkpatrick level is this?

Target word: level for a business outcome **Decides:** Injury rate is an organizational result.

A	Inverted operation	The lowest level, the opposite end from results.
B	Correct	A business outcome tied to the training.
C	Adjacent category	Behavior would be observing safe practices, not the injury rate.
D	Confusion set	Learning is a knowledge test, not an outcome.

10. Answer A Concept 7

In an HR SWOT analysis for a regional bank, the team lists that a new state law will require paid family leave for all employers next year. ~~The bank has 2,200 employees and strong brand recognition.~~ Where does the new law belong?

Target word: SWOT quadrant **Decides:** The law is an outside condition.

A	Correct	Laws and market conditions are external.
B	Adjacent category	Weaknesses are internal shortcomings, not outside rules.
C	Absolute language	PESTLE findings feed the O and T boxes of a SWOT.
D	Camouflage	The brand is a separate internal fact.

11. Answer B Concept 7 · transfer

Which item belongs in the Weaknesses box of an HR SWOT?

Target word: pick the internal negative **Decides:** Weakness = internal and unfavorable.

A	Inverted operation	Internal but favorable, so a strength.
B	Correct	An internal limitation.
C	Adjacent category	External, so a threat.
D	Confusion set	External competitive move, so a threat.

12. Answer C Concept 8

An HR analyst ~~at a 5,000-employee insurer~~ finds that employees who joined the voluntary wellness program have 30% lower turnover than those who did not. ~~The program is run by a well-known vendor and costs \$150 per person.~~ The CHRO wants to announce that the program cuts turnover. What is the best response?

Target word: can we claim cause? **Decides:** Participation was voluntary; engaged people may self-select.

A	Camouflage	Cost data do not establish cause.
B	Inverted operation	Reverses the direction with no evidence.
C	Correct	Self-selection could explain the gap.
D	Absolute language	A large gap does not prove cause.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	4	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Turnover rate	Turnover = separations ÷ average headcount for the period.	Dividing by starting or ending headcount, or counting hires.	Start and end headcounts plus a separations count.
2	Cost per hire	Cost per hire = (external + internal recruiting costs) ÷ number of hires.	Counting only agency and ad fees.	Two cost buckets and a hire count.
3	HR program ROI	ROI = (benefit – cost) ÷ cost.	Reporting benefit ÷ cost, or dividing by benefit.	A program cost and an estimated dollar benefit.
4	Strategic (vertical) fit	HR practices should support the business strategy: cost leaders need efficiency; differentiators invest in skills and service.	Assuming more generous HR practices are always better.	A stated competitive strategy and a proposed HR practice.
5	Balanced scorecard perspectives	Financial, customer, internal process, and learning and growth; people-capability measures belong in learning and growth.	Filing training or skills measures under internal process.	Classify a workforce measure on a scorecard.
6	Kirkpatrick's four levels	Level 1 reaction, 2 learning, 3 behavior on the job, 4 business results.	Treating a happy-sheet score as proof the training worked.	What is measured after training, and when.
7	SWOT: internal vs. external	Strengths and weaknesses are internal; opportunities and threats are external conditions.	Filing an outside law or labor shortage as a weakness.	A fact about the market, law or labor pool vs. about the firm itself.
8	Correlation is not causation in HR analytics	A link between a program and an outcome does not prove the program caused it; self-selection and other factors must be ruled out.	Claiming a voluntary program caused a better outcome.	People who chose to join a program show better results.

Course scope (public description): The HRM Capstone is your opportunity to bring together everything you have learned in your program. In this culminating course, you will evaluate HR strategies, assess organizational effectiveness, and recommend improvements that support both people and business outcomes. This experience showcases your readiness to step into HR roles where strategic vision and practical execution must work hand in hand.